Roadmap

Ticked means built, tested and deployed. This is the page to keep current.

Last updated: 17 September 2026.

Phase 0 — the management system (done, running)

The shop has been using this for a while. Listed so the rest has context.

- ✓ Visits, services, customers, barbers
- ✓ Cash drawer: open, movements, close, reconcile, shift and day reports
- ✓ Payment by cash, card, **InstaPay**, or any mix of the three
- ✓ Expenses and advances, per account (cash / card / InstaPay)
- ✓ Payroll: commissions, advances, penalties, attendance
- ✓ Warehouse: purchases, suppliers, issue notes, stocktakes
- ✓ Reports and the owner's overview, discounts, activity trail
- ✓ Logins end after 2 hours, or 30 minutes idle, on shop devices

Phase 1 — booking core (done)

✓ **1a** Appointment model; opening hours, barber hours, time off, who does what; service lengths; the free-slot rules, tested including the summer clock change

✓ **1b** Appointments API and the shop's diary: book, move, arrived, no-show, cancel; booking settings screen; no double-booking, enforced on save

✓ **1c** Customer accounts by phone number; the customer app (`/app`): book, see, cancel, profile; staff and customers walled apart, with tests

Phase 2 — the till side (done)

The piece that makes booking worth having: one appointment, one visit, one set of figures.

- ✓ Ring up an appointment → it becomes a `Visit`, exactly once, carrying its lines
- ✓ A customer who leaves without paying: closed as **done, not paid**, counted nowhere
- ✓ Walk-ins: the same appointment as a booking, starting now, in a live queue
- ✓ Live queue screen: in a chair, waiting with an estimated wait, expected today
- ✓ Seat a customer: assign a barber and start them, one barber per chair
- ✓ Today at a glance for the owner: booked, walk-ins, completed, no-shows, takings

- ✓ No-shows counted, with what they cost, on the overview and in the day journal
- ✓ Who appears in the customer app is the shop's choice, per person

Phase 3 — keeping customers (done)

- ✓ Barber logins and their own day: schedule, their customers, their earnings
- ✓ Customer notes the barber sees ("low fade, same as last time")
- ✓ Barber profiles in the customer app: photo, bio, book with them
- ✓ Reminders the day before, and a booking confirmation — on the phone itself, free
- ✓ Offers, shown in the app (a notice, never a price the till enforces)
- ✓ Reviews after a visit: stars and a line, asked for on the phone the day after

Reminders go to the phone as a notification, not as a text message: there is nothing to pay per message and no sender name to register. The customer turns them on once, from their profile in the app. On an iPhone they must first add the app to the Home Screen — Apple allows notifications only then — and the app says so plainly instead of failing quietly. A booking is confirmed straight away, and a reminder goes out the evening before.

Needs from you: photos for each barber whenever you have them; the slots are already in place, and a line of bio can be written on the barbers screen today. An SMS or WhatsApp provider is no longer needed for reminders, and would only add reach to customers who never install the app — worth revisiting once we see how many turn notifications on.

Phase 4 — the phone apps

- ○ React Native (Expo) app over the same API
- ✓ Push notifications (already working in the web app; the phone apps inherit them)
- ○ Android build, then submission to Google Play
- ○ iPhone build, then submission to the App Store

Needs from you: a Google Play account (one-off $25) and an Apple Developer account ($99 a year). The accounts must be in the shop's name, and only you can submit. I build the apps and prepare the listings.

The app's look and the customer's own record (done)

- ✓ **Brass & Ink** across the customer and barber apps: one set of tokens, square corners, hairline rules, brass on the one action that matters, and Bodoni on anything read as a number
- ✓ Light and dark, switched in the header and remembered on that phone

✓ The customer owns their record: their picture, name, the number they sign in with, and the birthday the shop wishes them on

✓ The shop's till screens deliberately untouched — worked on for eight hours a day, and still white

Phase 11 — reaching the people who work here (in progress)

✓ A barber signs in with the phone in their hand and a PIN, so the day screen, earnings, portfolio, time off and cut reports reach all 26

✓ A walk-in can be reviewed, so the shop's actual traffic can rate its cuts

✓ A QR on every receipt, so the app reaches the people already in the chair

✓ A customer's own haircuts, years of them, a page at a time

✓ A receipt for any of them, theirs to keep and to send

✓ The price list and the roster, open to anybody without an account

✓ A barber's own work shown while choosing one, not only on their profile

✓ An invitation that carries the code in the link, and goes by WhatsApp

✓ "The usual" reads walk-ins too, so a regular who never books still has one

✓ "Is it worth walking down now" — the live queue when the shop runs one, and what usually happens at this hour when it does not

> This started as "every walk-in becomes a diary entry", on the assumption that zero appointments was starving six features. Checking first showed it starves exactly one: loyalty and the rebooking nudge already read visits, reminders are about cuts still to come, and a walk-in cannot miss an appointment it never made. Only reviews were blocked. Writing 6,588 retroactive appointments to unlock one feature would have wrecked the diary counts, the barber's day screen and the appointments list — so the review learned about visits instead. What actually starves loyalty and the nudges is one customer login and no push subscriptions, which is a different problem.

Phase 10 — the conversation around the chair (done)

✓ Photos of the cut a customer wants, on the barber's day screen and their file

✓ A report on a cut from whoever was standing there, read by the owner alone — from the barber's day screen on a booked cut, and from the till on a walk-in, which is nearly all of them

Phase 9 — the awkward customer (done)

✓ A no-show policy that asks for a deposit rather than barring anybody

Phase 8 — the room itself (done)

- ✓ The screen on the wall: the live queue, the wait, and today's offers
- ✓ Barbers asking for their own time off, approved in a tap
- ✓ A barber's own portfolio of work on their profile

Phase 7 — the counter (done)

- ✓ Sell products on a visit: the money on the takings, the stock off the shelf
- ✓ A waiting list when the day is full, offered to the first in line when somebody cancels
- ✓ Deposits by InstaPay for the long, expensive services

Phase 6 — the chair, filled (done)

Three things aimed at the customers the shop already has, rather than at finding new ones.

- ✓ **The usual** — their barber, their cut and the times nearest their hour, booked in one tap from the home screen
- ✓ The owner's nightly digest on the phone: takings, no-shows, tomorrow
- ✓ "It's been a while" — a nudge when a regular is past their own rhythm

Phase 5 — loyalty and depth (done)

- ✓ Loyalty: a punch card — a stamp per paid visit, a reward you describe
- ✓ Referrals and birthday offers
- ✓ Deeper reports: retention, busiest times, barber utilisation, new versus returning
- ✓ Customer groups, and a notification the owner can send one of them

Kept in mind, not scheduled

- Deposits or paying online — needs a gateway and a refund policy
- A second branch — the model allows it; nothing is built for it
- Forgot-password for customers — safest once SMS exists; until then the shop resets it

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Quality

- ✓ 478 tests: 212 on the rules, 266 on the API against a real database

✓ Every endpoint tested for what it does *and* who it refuses

✓ A walk through the preview shop end to end (`npm run test:preview`), kept out of the suite so a green run means the code is sound rather than that Docker was up

○ Tests for the screens themselves (clicking through a browser)

Open questions

1. **Cancellation window** is 2 hours. Right for Escape?
2. **Who shows in the app** — new barbers appear by default. Turn anyone off on the barbers screen ("takes bookings in the customer app"); owners and managers with a login are hidden automatically.
3. **Three bookings at once** per customer. Enough?
4. ~~**No-show policy**~~ — answered: nobody is blocked. A customer who has missed twice recently is asked for a deposit on anything they book, and the shop can wipe their slate from their page. Off until you turn it on, on the deposits screen.
5. **Service lengths** are seeded estimates (haircut 30, beard 20, protein 120). They decide how many slots a day holds, so they are worth correcting on the services screen.
6. **Rewards are switched off until you set them up** — the loyalty card, referrals and birthdays all wait on Setup → Rewards, where you decide how many visits earn what.

How to try it

The hosted demo

https://escape-barbershop-demo.vercel.app — a separate deployment with its own database, holding sixteen invented customers and six weeks of plausible trade. Nothing real is in it, which is the point: the live shop's database has thousands of actual customers and their phone numbers, and is never what gets shown to anybody.

Role	Sign in at	Username	Password
Owner	`/login`	`demo@escape.com`	`demo-owner-2026`
Cashier	`/login`	`cashier@escape.com`	`demo-till-2026`
Barber	`/login`	`01000000002`	`482913`
Customer	`/app/login`	`01032824493`	`demo-customer-2026`

The discount and edit PIN is `1234` . `/app/prices` and `/app/roster` need no account at all. The customer and barber accounts are attached to the busiest people in the demo, so their history, loyalty

and earnings have something in them rather than opening empty.

The demo data is dated, so its "today" goes stale; re-running `db:seed:demo` against that database refreshes it.

On your own machine

`docker compose up --build`, then http://localhost:3100. Sign in with the accounts printed in the log; the customer app is at `/app`, and you can create a customer account from there with any Egyptian mobile number.
